

Unit 1.0 — Values and Ethics in Day-to-Day Life

| 1.1 Values, Ethics, and Attitude — Definitions

Values: Personal beliefs or standards that a person considers important and desirable, guiding their behaviour and choices in life. They are internal and individual in nature. **Examples of values:** Humanity, honesty, punctuality, respect, peace, empathy.

Ethics: A set of moral principles or rules of conduct, generally set by an organization, profession, or society, that govern acceptable behaviour. They are external/social standards that a person is expected to follow. **Examples of ethics:** Healthy competition, integrity, truthfulness, professional conduct.

Difference between Values and Ethics: Values are personal preferences/beliefs and may vary from person to person, while ethics are standardized norms of behaviour set by authorities/society that everyone in that context is expected to follow. Values may sometimes conflict with workplace ethics.

Attitude: A person's settled way of thinking or feeling about someone/something, which influences behaviour.

Development of attitude: Attitudes are shaped by upbringing, family environment, education, culture, personal experiences, and social interactions over time.

| 1.2 Importance of Values and Ethics

Importance in day-to-day activities and at the workplace: - Builds trust and credibility among colleagues, clients, and society. - Improves decision-making and reduces conflicts. - Enhances reputation of an individual/organization. - Ensures fair treatment and a positive working environment.

Ethical ways of communication: Being honest, transparent, respectful, and avoiding misinformation or manipulation while communicating with others.

Environmental considerations in engineering processes: Engineers must consider the environmental impact of their designs/processes — minimizing waste, pollution, and resource depletion.

Carbon footprint: The total amount of greenhouse gases (mainly CO₂) emitted directly or indirectly by an individual, organization, or product/process. Reducing carbon footprint is an ethical responsibility of engineers towards sustainability.

Ethics at workplace: Includes punctuality, honesty in reporting, respecting colleagues, maintaining confidentiality, avoiding conflicts of interest, and following organizational policies.

| 1.3 Situations Depicting Values-based Decisions

Examples include: returning extra change received by mistake (honesty), reporting to work on time consistently (punctuality), helping a struggling colleague without expecting credit (empathy), admitting a mistake instead of blaming others (integrity), and resolving disagreements calmly without aggression (peace).

Unit 2.0 — Values and Ethics in Profession

2.1 Relevance of Profession to Society

Every profession exists to serve a need of society. Engineers, in particular, have a direct responsibility towards public safety, welfare, and the environment, since their work (infrastructure, software, machinery) directly affects people's lives. Professional competence combined with ethical responsibility ensures that technology benefits society without causing harm.

2.2 Ethical Principles in Professional Life

- **Respecting others and ourselves:** Treating colleagues, clients, and oneself with dignity and consideration.
- **Respecting the rights of others:** Acknowledging others' opinions, intellectual property, and personal boundaries.
- **Keeping promises:** Honouring commitments and deadlines given to colleagues, clients, or employers.
- **Avoiding unnecessary problems to others:** Being considerate in actions/decisions so as not to cause inconvenience or harm to others.
- **Avoiding cheating and dishonesty:** Maintaining integrity in exams, reporting, billing, and professional dealings — never misrepresenting facts or taking credit for others' work (plagiarism, fraud).
- **Showing gratitude towards others and encouraging them to work:** Appreciating contributions of team members, motivating colleagues, fostering a positive and collaborative work culture.

2.3 Identifying Ethical and Unethical Behaviour

Ethical Behaviour	Unethical Behaviour
Submitting original work	Plagiarism/copying others' work
Reporting errors honestly	Hiding mistakes/falsifying data
Following safety protocols	Ignoring safety standards to save time/cost
Respecting confidentiality	Leaking sensitive organizational information
Fair competition	Sabotaging a colleague's work or bribery

Ethical conflicts: Situations where a person's personal values, organizational policies, and professional ethics may not align, requiring careful judgment to resolve — e.g., being asked to certify substandard work to meet a deadline.

2.4 Situations Depicting Ethical Behaviour

Examples: An engineer refusing to approve unsafe construction material despite pressure from management (integrity over convenience); a software developer disclosing a security vulnerability instead of hiding it (transparency); a student refraining from copying in an examination despite opportunity (honesty); resolving a dispute between two colleagues by mediating fairly rather than taking sides (fairness).

Related concepts for discussion/seminars: - *Charters of professions:* Formal documents/codes of conduct that define the ethical responsibilities of a profession (e.g., Code of Ethics for Engineers). - *Professional rivalry:* Healthy competition among professionals should be based on merit and quality of work, not unethical practices like sabotage or false claims. - *Lessons from Chanakya Neeti and scriptures (e.g., Kabir ke Dohe):* Ancient Indian wisdom emphasizing honesty, hard work, humility, and ethical conduct — relevant even in modern professional contexts.